THAMARAI DESIGNERS

DESIGN LANGUAGE · BRAND GUIDELINES

Quiet luxury, *hand-stitched.*

The colour, type, shape, motion and imagery system behind the Thamarai Designers website: a warm, artisanal look for bespoke embroidered blouses and couture made in Coimbatore.



Edition 1.0 · October 2026
Source of truth: `style.css`, `index.html`, `script.js`

01 Brand essence
02 Colour
03 Typography
04 Shape, depth & texture
05 Components
06 Motion, layout & imagery

Heritage craft, presented softly.

Thamarai (தாமரை) means *lotus*. The design follows the same idea: a calm, ivory-and-clay surface that steps back so the embroidery and colour of each garment come first. Everything should feel handmade, warm and unhurried, never loud or corporate.

Brand voice

Gentle, poetic and specific. Talk about the hand-tied thread, the loom room, the maker's care. Use words like *artisanal, heirloom, bespoke, homegrown, refined*. Never show a price up front; the site always says *"Price on enquiry"*, which keeps conversations personal.

Tagline system

Handcrafted Elegance — site title

Bespoke Embroidery — footer signature

Artisanal Heritage — story eyebrow

Five design principles

i. **Warm neutrals**

Parchment and clay, never pure white or black. Every tone has brown in it.

ii. **Garment first**

The UI has little colour of its own, so the photography carries the saturation.

iii. **Soft geometry**

Generous radii, pill tags and diffuse shadows. Nothing sharp.

iv. **Airy spacing**

Wide letter-spacing and roomy gutters suggest slowness and care.

v. **Gentle motion**

Slow fades, floats and lifts. Things drift in; they never snap.

Do

- Let ivory panels float over the textured parchment background
- Use the serif for anything emotional: names, headings, quotes
- Keep clay brown for actions and labels only
- Use translucent, warm-tinted borders (clay at 14–35% opacity)

Don't

- Introduce cool greys, blues or neon accents into the UI
- Use bold sans-serif weights for headlines
- Use hard black drop shadows or square corners
- Crowd product imagery with copy or badges

Parchment, clay & walnut.

An earthy palette taken from raw silk, sandalwood and terracotta. Five core tokens are defined on `:root`; supporting tones are tints and alpha variants of the same brown family.

Core tokens

Parchment
`#ECE0CF`
`--bg-color`
Page background, the base canvas

Ivory Silk
`#FFF5E8`
`--wood-light`
Panels, cards, nav bar

Clay
`#8C5C36`
`--clay-red`
Primary accent: CTAs, labels, links

Walnut
`#6A4329`
`--wood-dark`
Wordmark, icons, product codes

Umber Ink
`#3B2F24`
`--text-color`
Body text and headings

Supporting tones

Antique Gold
`#A67C52`
Dividers, badge tints, hover borders

Marigold Peach
`#F7C28E`
Gradient end of WhatsApp CTA

Cream
`#FFF7E9 · panel 96%`
--panel-bg, mobile drawer

Deep Teak
`#4B3B2D · #3A2F25`
Card titles, story heading

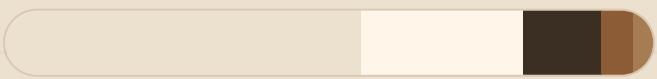
Cocoa
`#5E4B3D`
Badge text

Charcoal Body
`#3D3D3D @ 75–82%`
Long-form paragraphs

Scrim
`#2C1C0F @ 45%`
Mobile menu overlay

Saffron Gradient
`135° Gold → Peach`
Floating enquiry button

Usage proportion



≈55% parchment · 25% ivory · 12% ink · 5% clay · 3% gold. Clay is rare on purpose, so it always reads as "act here".

Alpha conventions

USE	VALUE
Hairline borders	`rgba(140,92,54, .14–.18)`
Pill / tag outline	`rgba(140,92,54, .30–.35)`
Badge / icon fill	`rgba(166,124,82, .10–.12)`
Warm shadow	`rgba(84,56,34, .08–.10)`

A couture serif, a whispering sans.

Two Google Fonts pairing an editorial, high-contrast serif with a light, widely tracked geometric sans. The serif carries the emotion; the sans carries the information. The smaller the text, the wider the tracking: every uppercase string gets at least 2px letter-spacing.

DISPLAY · HEADINGS · NAMES

Aa

Cormorant Garamond

Weights: 300 Light, 500 Medium, 300 *Italic*.
Used for the wordmark, page titles, product names (italic) and section headings.

BODY · UI · LABELS

Aa

Montserrat

Weights: 200 ExtraLight, 300 Light, 400 Regular (600 only on the WhatsApp CTA and contact links).
Used for body copy, navigation, eyebrow labels and product codes.

Type scale

GALLERY HERO Serif italic · 4rem	*The Gallery*
PAGE H2 Serif 300 · clamp(2.5–4rem) · lh 1.02	Model-inspired elegance
WORDMARK Serif · 1.8rem · tracking 6px	THAMARAI DESIGNERS
CARD TITLE Serif italic · 1.5rem	*Royal Silk*
BODY Sans 300 · 1rem · lh 1.8–1.95 · 75–82% opacity	Every piece begins with a hand-tied thread and a maker's care.
EYEBROW LABEL Sans · 0.75–0.8rem · tracking 3–6px · Clay	EXCLUSIVE STYLING
NAV LINK Sans · 0.7rem · tracking 2px	COLLECTIONS
PRODUCT CODE Sans · 0.62–0.72rem · tracking 2.4–3px	TD-BL-014 · HAND ZARDOSI

Pebble-soft forms on ruled paper.

Surfaces are rounded like river stones, lifted with large, low-opacity warm shadows, and laid on a parchment ground with faint horizontal ruling, like a tailor's pattern sheet.

Corner radius scale



RADIUS	APPLIED TO
12px	Hamburger button
18px	Info rows on the product-detail page
24px	Images inside cards, map frame, detail image
28–32px	Product cards, marquee items, image containers, story panels
40px	The Our Story page shell (largest surface)
999px	All buttons, tags, badges, the "Price on enquiry" chip

Elevation

Resting `0 24 70 / .08 warm`

Hover lift -10px `0 44 120 / .16`

Hero / page shell `0 40 120–130 / .10–.14`

Background texture

Parchment base plus a 12% white top-glow and a 1px umber line (3% opacity) repeating every 38px. It is subtle, but it gives a paper feel.

```
repeating-linear-gradient(180deg,
 rgba(59,44,31,.03) 0 1px, transparent 1px 38px)
```

Glass & glow

The nav, story shell, contact panels and floating CTA use `backdrop-filter: blur(12–14px)` over translucent cream. Large radial "sun-glows" in peach (`#FFE8D1`) and gold sit behind the story panels, and images get a soft white top-left sheen.

The building blocks.

NAVIGATION BAR

THAMARAI DESIGNERS COLLECTIONS OUR STORY CONTACT

PRODUCT CARD · PRIMARY → SECONDARY IMAGE SWAP ON HOVER



Forest Zardosi

TD · EMERALD

PRICE ON ENQUIRY



Temple Gold

TD · MAROON

PRICE ON ENQUIRY

Left: resting. Right: hover. The card lifts 10px, turns white, the border warms to gold, and the image scales 1.06× with a 0.35° tilt.

PRIMARY ACTION

Enquire on WhatsApp

Solid clay, white text, pill. Max width 280px.

FLOATING ENQUIRY (ALWAYS VISIBLE)

Chat to Enquire

Gold→peach gradient, glass blur, fixed bottom-right.

BADGES

Artisanal weaving

Handcrafted in Tamil Nadu

Premium homegrown luxury

CONTACT ICON · EYEBROW · DIVIDER

✉ ARTISANAL HERITAGE

STORY IMAGE TAG · FROSTED PILL OVER PHOTOGRAPHY



Unhurried by design.

Motion

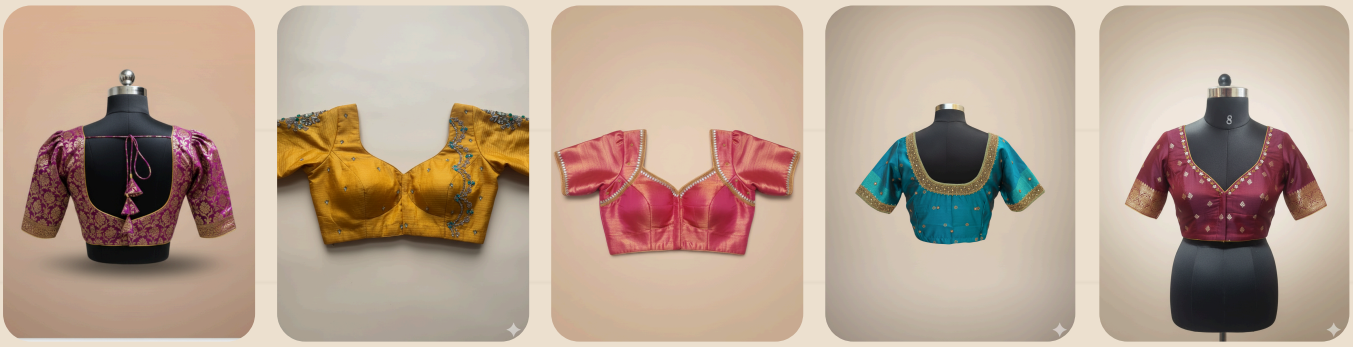
MOMENT	SPEC
Page enter	slideUpFade 1.2s · `cubic-bezier(.19,1,.22,1)` · +30px
Grid reveal	cardReveal 0.85s, staggered +80ms per card
Scroll reveal	sections fade up 40px over 1s
Marquee	40s linear loop, pauses on hover / drag
Ambient float	cards −10px / 8s, hero −12px / 12s, alternate
Hover	0.35s ease lift; images 0.6–0.8s `(.2,1,.3,1)`
Drawer	0.35s `(.4,0,.2,1)` slide from right

Signature easing is an expo-out curve: fast start, long, silky settle.

Layout & breakpoints

TOKEN	VALUE
Side gutter	5% (4% on mobile)
Max content	1180–1340px
Product grid	auto-fit, min 320px, 48–60px gap
Split sections	1.1fr / 0.9fr, or 1.2fr / 1fr
Image ratio	3 : 4 portrait
≤ 980 / 860px	Stack columns, hamburger drawer
≤ 600px	2-column grid, 18px gap, radii shrink to 16–24px
≤ 380px	Single column

Imagery



- Portrait 3:4 crops, garment centred, embroidery in sharp focus
- Warm, soft, diffused light; backgrounds in creams, beiges or muted interiors
- Jewel-tone garments (emerald, maroon, plum, ochre, teal) are the only saturated colour on the page
- Always shown inside rounded containers with a soft shadow, never full-bleed edge-to-edge
- Hover adds a slight boost: `saturate(1.05–1.08) contrast(1.05)`
- Product names are evocative pairs: *colour or material + technique* (Forest Zardosi, Ochre Pearl)